

UTT Chapter 08 Assignment

Hello there!

I learned a valuable lesson today while I was biking to class; never leave home without an umbrella. As I am sure you can guess, I was caught in a torrential downpour. After the first few minutes, I embraced the flood and attempted to enjoy the remaining ten minutes of my bike ride. By the time I walked into class though, I looked like I had jumped into a lake. I bet it was a pretty funny sight. My Art History professor enjoyed teasing me about tracking water into her class. I have absolutely learned my lesson.

On a positive, and much drier, note, Sarah and Nathan had a really cool idea to start a book club at a local coffee shop near campus. Mark, Paige, and Muhammad joined our discussion too! Today was the first day, and we were supposed to pick out a book. We couldn't really settle on a genre, so the conversation basically turned into a discussion on what each person wanted to read. Sarah wanted to read about the rise of the feminist movement, but Nathan suggested a book on meditation and self-healing. To be honest, I am still a bit confused by what he was saying. I could understand more of it than I did before I read your letter. Thanks again!

Somehow, our conversation shifted towards everyone's belief in the supernatural. Muhammad and I agreed in the existence of God, but Sarah and Mark kept saying it was an irrational conclusion since we can't experience him with our five senses. Nathan was on a completely different planet when he was trying to explain that we are all gods. Paige was pretty quiet, but she did mention something about not conforming to the metanarratives set forth by mainstream religions. I bet this has something to do with her thoughts on Postmodernism.

After about two hours of listening to them—mainly Sarah and Mark versus Nathan—we decided to meet up next week with some specific books in mind. I am not sure what book I will suggest. It is still strange to me that some people don't believe in God or believe we are all god. I know Muhammad and I at least agree that there is only one God, but we seem to part ways after that. He said Christianity believes in three gods. I tried to explain that the Trinity isn't three gods but one. However, I didn't do a very job. Muhammad remains unconvinced.

After I left, I began to think about all they said. Mark calls himself a Marxist, but Sarah says she is a Secularist. It seems like they agree about their theology, but it's hard to wrap my head around how anyone could deny that God exists. **Why do Secularists deny God's existence?** And **why do Marxists deny God's existence?** Also, Paige didn't really speak up too much this time. **How does Postmodernism view God?** Nathan, on the other hand, was calling all of us gods, saying we need to discover the inner divine in all of us. **What is the New Spiritualist view of God?** I'm hoping you can help me figure out how to explain Christian theology to Muhammad. I feel I need to know more about our differences. **What is the difference between the Islamic view of God and the Christian view of God?**

I really appreciate you taking the time to explain all this worldview stuff. It can be quite confusing when all your friends have different beliefs about God.

You are the BEST!

–Doug